



EPSF

The European PencakSilat Federation

Persekutuan Pencak Silat Eropa

130 Sherborne Court, 180-186 Cromwell Road, SW5 0SU, London, UK
Tel. +44 (0)7740 427 163,
Email: epsf2001@hotmail.com, epsf_treasury@yahoo.co.uk, Web: www.epsf.net

EPSF National Wasit Juri Course

Rationale

The standards of European Wasit Juri have frequently been the subject of discussions between EPSF and PERSILAT over the past few years. It is clear that raising the standards of Wasit Juri training to produce better trained Wasit Juri will directly influence the quality of national and international championships in Europe.

With a view to this, the President of the EPSF suggested in a meeting with PERSILAT at the end of August that the best way to start improving the standards of European Wasit Juri to that of its South East Asian counterparts was to facilitate a National Wasit Juri course, endorsed and run by PERSILAT. In agreement with this view PERSILAT kindly gave full endorsement for a National Wasit Juri course conducted by PERSILAT in London, hosted by PSF UK, with the trainer representing PERSILAT to be provided by the Singapore Silat Federation (PERSISI).

This course would be a pilot project aimed to provide EPSF member countries with a benchmark to raise the standards and quality of their National Wasit Juri training courses in future. The result will hopefully produce a better quality National European Wasit Juri as candidates for future International Wasit Juri courses run by PERSILAT.

In turn, as the quality of National and International Wasit Juri improves, the expectation is the quality of championships hosted in Europe will likewise improve.

The Wasit Juri Course

On 27-28 September, the Pencak Silat Federation of UK (PSF UK) hosted the first EPSF National Wasit Juri (referees and jury/officials) course, endorsed by PERSILAT and conducted on their behalf by Trainer and Wasit Juri First Class Mr Shafaq Ali Haq from the Singapore Silat Federation (PERSISI). The course was held at the Kilburn Park School in North West London, with all expenses borne by PSF UK.

Mr Shafaq is a highly experienced International Level One Wasit Juri who regularly trains Wasit Juri candidates in Singapore. To ensure that quality expectations were met, Mrs. Siti Badariah Hosni, Head of Coaching & Training Development for the European Pencak Silat Federation (EPSF) monitored the course and assisted with assessments, as well as learning about the recent changes to technical regulations.

The first full day of the training consisted of Mr Shafaq outlining the theory, the various rules, regulations & conduct expected of qualified national referees and officials. In addition, he also explained the new PERSILAT regulations on tournaments. This was followed by a second day of training where candidates had to apply what they had learned in a tournament under the assessment of Mr Shafaq.

All candidates passed the theory and practical exams with high marks, in spite of strict marking criteria set prior to the course.

The candidates were drawn from different clubs across the PSF UK, with the aim of enhancing the tournament infrastructure of the federation and to improve the standard of refereeing within Europe. The mini tournament was organised and conducted professionally following PERSILAT's benchmark and many PSF UK members who were not on the course also benefited from Mr Shafaq's expertise and experience.

The tournament was well attended with the Indonesian Embassy represented by Mr Yudho P Asruchin, Third Secretary, Information and Socio-Cultural Department and the Malaysian High Commission was represented by Mr M Hadrizammi Mustafa, First Secretary, Political Department. The press was also represented by local journalists and Indonesian news agencies ANTARA and Metro TV, who conducted interviews and filmed the tournament.

The guests of honour were Mr Sheik Alau'ddin Yacoob Marican, Consultant to PSAT for the World Championships 2015 in Thailand, and Mr Kasem Benchawong, Member of PERSILAT Marketing Board and Advisor to the President of the Pencak Silat Association of Thailand (PSAT). Both gave a joint presentation at the mini tournament on the forthcoming World Championships to be held in Phuket in January 2015. This was very well received making the course and the tournament a success with a good turnout and press coverage.